

Darwin Core Maintenance Group call

2026-09-07 12:30 UTC

Attendees:

John Wieczorek, Peter Desmet, Jörg H. Cecilie S., Tim R., Kate I.

Regrets: Steve Baskauf, Paula Zermoglio

The next meeting should be on 5 October 2026 (the first Monday) at 12:30 UTC.

- I. Ongoing public review (see https://dwc.tdwg.org/public_review/) :
 - A. We are in the 30 day quiet period for issues that have achieved consensus (16 August - 15 September) followed by Executive Committee approval (hopefully first Exec meeting after 15 September).
 - B. [Status of review](#)
 - C. [DwC-DP Quick Reference Guide](#) and [DwC-DP Designer](#) reflect changes
- II. Management process for changes ratified by public review
 - A. Conceptual Model
 1. GeologicalMaterial
 2. ChronometricAge
 - Agreement that we should try and discuss the changes necessary to the CM within the class term proposal as they are added to the issue tracker. Issue templates should reflect this. This should happen for GeologicalMaterial and any other missing classes in the [next public review](#). JW - Issue templates updated 2026-09-08.
 - For those already proposed we proceed without the CM change
 - Open issue(s) to document each class not covered in the CM but in DwC
 - Ask for help from the initiator to produce the documentation

JW: [Issue](#) created for GeologicalMaterial. No issues created for Assertion, BibliographicResource, MaterialSample (effectively deprecated), MeasurementOrFact, Provenance, ResourceRelationship, or UsagePolicy.
 - B. schemas <https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues/930>
 1. Parts of DwC Standard
 - a) isPartOf <http://www.tdwg.org/standards/450>
 2. DwC-A
 - a) decision-making process and responsibilities
 - The MG will make schema changes in good faith based on the consensus term changes and additions within a given public review (they will not be presented in final form for public review, which would require an additional public review cycle). Ideally the

implications on schemas should be discussed in public review as an integral component of term changes or additions.

- b) Approach to managing existing schemas the first time they are incorporated into the standard with the [current public review](#) - maintain the status quo as nearly as possible, for now. More complex improvements should be presented in issues for public review going forward. - Agreed

3. DwC-DP versioning

- a) version "1.0-DEV" - in development during the review process
- b) version "1.0-RC.1" - release candidate presented to the Executive as an artifact of a public review
- c) version 1.0 - production-ready version following ratification

C. MG decision whether the DNA-derived data Extension will be managed by the MG.

- 1. See <https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues/1039>.
- 2. This particular extension can't be produced by the script that produces all other XML schemas as it currently stands. Not only would the metadata for the terms from <https://w3id.org/mixs/>, <http://rs.gbif.org/terms/miqe/>, <http://rs.gbif.org/terms/>, and <http://data.ggbn.org/schemas/ggbn/terms/> need to be managed in <https://github.com/tdwg/rs.tdwg.org/tree/master> (with folders mixs-for-dwc, miqe-for-dwc, ggbn-for-dwc, and gbif-for-dwc), but also the script would have to be modified to accommodate the mixs opaque identifier to term label mapping.
- 3. Decision: MG can take this over. GBIF recommends it. Cannot/should not be managed by the MG until the necessary rs.tdwg.org prerequisites are in place to maintain it using build_xml.py as is the case for all other XMLS schemas managed by the MG. - GBIF will solve this (Thomas, Matt, Tim)

D. Process, Patterns, and Precedents document (Conventions)

- 1. Example: <https://github.com/tdwg/ac/blob/master/policies.md>
- 2. Issue tracking
- 3. controlled vocabulary examples
- 4. namespace abbreviations on terms
- 5. lists
- 6. iri term references
- 7. example syntax
- 8. RFC keywords usage/avoidance
- 9. MOUs (GSC, potentially GBIF and OBIS) - Discussed that no MOU is needed for GBIF or OBIS as their method of participation is already covered by the public review process.

PD - suggested that we can amplify the Guidelines for contributing document (.github/CONTRIBUTING.md) with this information.

JW: [Issue](#) created to update the Contributing document.

PD - suggested a release issue template with checkboxes for all of the steps required to create a release. (See <https://github.com/inbo/camtrapdp/issues/218> for example).

JW: [Issue](#) created to make such a template.

E. Public meeting notes

Agreed that this is needed, but no further discussion yet.

JW: Included mention of public MG meeting notes in [Contributing Guideline update issue](#).

III. Convenership

- A. Agreement amongst those present that John can take over from Steve following this public review. That he would be called "Sauron" was hotly debated. "Gandalf" was less contentious.

IV. Other business

CS to make issue of including borrowed terms in the terms list. See <https://github.com/tdwg/dwc/issues/1059>